Sobia Paracha

Postdoctoral Fellow

Department of PGovernment
University of Texas at Austin
Austin, Texas
sobiaparacha@austin.utexas.edu

Education

2026 **Ph.D. Political Science**, *Syracuse University*, Syracuse, NY
Specializations: International Relations, Comparative Politics, Quantitative Methods.
Dissertation: *To Claim or Deny: Political Contestation and Nationalist Rhetoric about Territories*
Committee: Brian Taylor (Chair), Ryan Griffiths, Erin Hern, Naushin Husain

2012 **Master by Research in War Studies**, *King's College*, London
Thesis: Military Implications of Indian Space Program (Distinction)

2008 **M.Sc. in Defense & Strategic Studies**, *Quaid-i-Azam University*, Islamabad
Seminar: Safety and Security of Pakistan's Nuclear Complex

2006 **B.A. in Political Science and Economics**, *University of Punjab*, Lahore

Research Agenda

In Progress Fluctuating Elite Nationalism and the Kashmir Dispute: A Longitudinal Computational Analysis of Pakistani Press Discourse. *Targeting: Wprld Politics*. (Draft available)

In Progress Security Without Voice: Discursive Suppression and Elite Strategy towards Pakistan's Borderlands. *Targeting: Nations and Nationalism*.

Working Paper Contested Identity: A Comparative Study of State Formation in Post-Colonial Pakistan and Argentina.

Publications & Research

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

Paracha, Sobia. 2013. Military Dimensions of the Indian Space Program. *Astropolitics* 11, no. 3: 156–186.

Book

Paracha, Sobia. 2017. *Indian Defence Budget and Conventional Modernization*. Monograph. Islamabad: Islamabad Policy Research Institute (IPRI). ISBN: 978-969-8721-61-9.

Selected Policy Papers & Technical Briefs

Paracha, Sobia. 2009. *Strategic Export Controls: Case Study of Pakistan*. Research Report. London/Islamabad: South Asian Strategic Stability Institute (SASSI).

Khan, Maria, and Sobia Paracha. 2009. Strategic Brief: Kerry-Lugar Bill Uncut. *SASSI Policy Brief*. London: South Asian Strategic Stability Institute.

Khan, Maria, and Sobia Paracha. 2008. Technical Brief: A Comparison between the Indo-US Nuclear Deal and Different IAEA Safeguards Systems. *SASSI Technical Report*. London: South Asian Strategic Stability Institute.

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record

Summer 2025, 2024 and 2022 **PSC 124 – International Relations**, *Syracuse University*
Designed and delivered a hybrid seminar-lecture course for 30 students. Focused on the bargaining model of war, international security and political economy and institutions. Introduced foundational concepts of IR paradigms, colonialism and post colonialism. Mentored diverse undergraduate cohorts in developing analytical writing and critical policy evaluation skills.

Spring 2022 **PSC 300 – International Organization**, *Syracuse University*
Upper-division elective exploring the evolution of the UN and regional bodies. Examined the efficacy of international law and institutional design in managing transborder conflicts and human rights.

Teaching Associate

2023–2026 **Quantitative Methods for the Social Sciences**, *Professors Andrew London and William Oliver*, (Four labs per week, grading 35 assignments, two exams, a labs skill test and mentoring 25 students to write individual research papers) , Syracuse University

2022 **Political Analysis**, *Professor Liwu Gan*, Syracuse University

2020–2021 **Issues and Actors in International Relations**, *Professor Jim Steinberg*, (Graduate Seminar) , Syracuse University

2020 **International Relations**, *Professor Daniel McDowell*, Syracuse University

2019 **Comparative Law and Courts**, *Professor Yuksel Sezgin*, Syracuse University

2019 **Ethics and International Relations**, *Professor Glyn Morgan*, Syracuse University

2018 **International Relations**, *Professor Terrell Northrop*, Syracuse University

Research Grants & Fellowships

2025 Roscoe Martin Fund for Dissertation Research in India, Syracuse University ($1,500).

2024 Stuart Thorson Award for ICPSR (Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research) Summer School ($3,000).

2024 Program for the Advancement of Research on Conflict and Collaboration (PARCC) Grant ($2,000).

2024 Roscoe Martin Fund for Dissertation Research in Pakistan, Syracuse University ($1,500).

2023 Bharati Memorial Award for Fieldwork in Pakistan, Moynihan Institute ($2,200).

2019–2020 Andrew Berlin Family National Security Research Grant ($3,000).

2014 United States Department of State, Technical Nuclear Safety and Security Scholarship (~$35,000).

2011–2012 Chevening Scholarship, British Foreign and Commonwealth Office (~£24,000).

2010–2011 National Defense University (NDU) Merit-Based Scholarship (PKR 50,000).

Technical Expertise & Methods

Computational Automated Content Analysis (Supervised & Unsupervised Topic Modeling), Natural Language Processing (NLP), Sentiment Analysis, and LLM Fine-tuning.

Econometric Causal Inference for Observational Data, Time-Series Cross-Sectional (TSCS) / Panel Analysis, Multi-level (Nested) Modeling, Discrete Choice Models (Multinomial Logit, Probit, OLS).

Programming Python (Pandas, NumPy, NLP libraries), R (Tidyverse, Quanteda, ggplot2), LaTeX, Stata, SPSS.

Data Management Archival Research (Pakistan); Digital Humanities: Text Extraction from Non-Digital Sources; Large-scale Data Storage (Parquet, SQL); Automated Corpus Construction.

Research Affiliations & Fellowships

2024–Present Selected Member, International Policy Scholars Consortium and Network (IPSCON).
Hosted by the Henry A. Kissinger Center for Global Affairs, Johns Hopkins SAIS. Funded by the Carnegie Corporation of New York.

Professional Experience

2015–2017 **Policy Consultant**, *Islamabad Policy Research Institute (IPRI)*
Authored a monograph on Indian defense budget, organized international conferences, and wrote op-eds on strategic issues.

2014 **Carnegie Scholar for Security**, *New America Foundation, Washington DC*
Research on Pak-US cooperation on nuclear security.

2014 **Visiting Research Scholar**, *Sandia National Labs, Albuquerque, NM*
Focused on nuclear security and international transparency.

2014 **Visiting Research Scholar**, *Center for International Trade and Security, University of Georgia*
Researched civilian oversight of Pakistan's nuclear program.

2013–2014 **Research Fellow**, *Strategic Vision Institute (SVI), Islamabad*
Worked on Indo-Pak nuclear balance and organized conferences on national security.

2013 **Visiting Faculty**, *Iqra University, Islamabad*
Taught global security trends to graduate students.

2008–2011 **Research Fellow**, *South Asian Strategic Stability Institute (SASSI)*
Led strategic export controls projects and contributed to policy on nuclear and regional security.

Select Presentations, Papers, and Conferences

2026 **Security Without Voice: Discursive Suppression and Elite Strategy in Pakistan's Borderlands**, *SPSA Annual Conference*, New Orleans

2025 **Nationalism on Demand: Divergent Elite Discourse on Pakistan's Territorial Disputes**, *Workshop on Inclusive Nationalism*, Yale University, Connecticut

2025 **Security Without Voice: Discursive Suppression and Elite Strategy in Pakistan's Borderlands**, *Association for the Study of Nationalities Annual Conference, Columbia University*, New York City

2024 **Entrenched or Abandoned: Nationalism and Elite Competition in Post Colonial Territorial Disputes**, *ISA Annual Conference*, San Francisco

2024 **Entrenched or Abandoned: Nationalism and Elite Competition in Post Colonial Territorial Disputes**, *MPSA Annual Conference*, Chicago

2022 **Territorial Disputes Categorization in Post-1945 States**, *MPSA Annual Conference*, Virtual

2019 **Conventional Deterrence and Nuclear First Use in South Asia**, *ISA Annual Conference*, Toronto

2015 **Emerging Indo-Pak Sea-Based Deterrents**, *International Student and Young Pugwash Conference*, Nagasaki

2015 **Space Programs of India and Pakistan**, *University of Gujrat*, Gujrat

2014 **Technical Aspects of Nuclear Security and Transparency**, *CRDF Global Headquarters*, Washington DC

Research Interests

- Computational Social Science
- Economy and Politics of Borders
- Nationalism
- Foreign Policy and Domestic Politics
- Strategic Dynamics of South Asia

Research Skills

Software Python, LaTeX, SPSS

Languages English, Urdu, Punjabi, Siraiki, Hindi, Farsi (beginner)

Institutional Service

2022 Graduate Student Representative, Tenure and Promotion Committee.

2020–2021 Organizer, Political Science Graduate Research Workshop.

2019–2020 Treasurer, Political Science Graduate Student Association (PSGSA).

Additional Training

Instructed in Nuclear Security Course by Pakistan Nuclear Regulatory Authority (2009 & 2010).

Organized and presented at institutional seminars and conferences.

Authored press releases and conference reports.

Appeared as a defense analyst on national television.

Received training as an anchorperson at Pakistan Television Network.

Referees

Dissertation Advisor
Professor Brian Taylor, *Director, Moynihan Institute of Global Affairs*, Syracuse University, bdtaylor@syr.edu
(315) 443-3713

Committee Member
Professor Ryan Griffiths, *Professor & Research Co-Director, International and Intra-State Conflict*, Syracuse University, rgriff01@syr.edu
(315)443-2416

Mentor
Professor Daniel McDowell, *Professor, Political Science Department*, 334 Eggers Hall, dmcdowel@syr.edu
(315) 443-2416

Teaching Professor
Dr. William Oliver, *Assistant Teaching Professor, Sociology Department*, 302 Maxwell Hall, wjoliver@syr.edu
(518) 391-8927